

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of Nuvaxovid or Cominarty for vaccination against COVID-19

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for COVID-19 Vaccination

Overview

- COVID-19 vaccination is the **primary public health measure** to reduce severe illness, hospitalisation, and death from SARS-CoV-2.
- Vaccines are regularly updated to cover **new variants** and used in targeted **seasonal campaigns** (e.g. spring and autumn boosters).

Vaccine Types

- **mRNA-based vaccines** (e.g. Pfizer-BioNTech, Moderna) are the **preferred vaccines** for all eligible age groups.
- **Protein-based vaccines** (e.g. Novavax) may be offered if mRNA vaccines are unsuitable.
- Updated **bivalent or variant-adapted vaccines** are used as needed.

Eligibility (as per most recent JCVI/NHS guidance):

Eligible groups typically include:

- Adults **aged 75 and over**
- Residents in **care homes for older adults**
- Individuals **aged 6 months and over** with **certain clinical risk factors** (e.g. immunosuppression, chronic health conditions)
- Frontline **health and social care workers**
- Those in **household contact** with immunocompromised individuals

Eligibility may change seasonally—refer to UKHSA/NHS updates for the current programme.

Dosing Schedules

- **Primary series:**
 - 2 doses for most individuals.
 - 3 doses for severely immunocompromised.
 - **Boosters:**
 - Offered **seasonally** (e.g. spring/autumn) to high-risk groups.
 - A **single dose** is given per campaign unless advised otherwise.
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Administration

- Administer **intramuscularly**, preferably into the **deltoid** muscle.
 - Can be co-administered with influenza and other vaccines where appropriate.
 - Observe for **15 minutes** post-vaccination if mRNA vaccine given.
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Contraindications

- History of **anaphylaxis** to a previous COVID-19 vaccine or a component (e.g. polyethylene glycol [PEG]).
 - Acute febrile illness (vaccination should be deferred until recovered).
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Precautions

- **Previous COVID-19 infection:** Defer vaccination until fully recovered. Wait at least:
 - **4 weeks** after positive test or symptom onset in most people.
 - **12 weeks** in children aged 5–17 unless at high risk.
 - Observe caution in people with a history of **myocarditis or pericarditis**—specialist advice may be needed.
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Side Effects

- Common: Sore arm, fatigue, headache, muscle aches, low-grade fever.
 - Rare: Anaphylaxis, myocarditis/pericarditis (mostly in young males after mRNA vaccines).
 - Advise patients on the **Yellow Card Scheme** for reporting suspected side effects.
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Documentation

- Record vaccine name, batch number, date, site, and route.

- Issue or update the **COVID-19 vaccination record** (e.g. NHS App or patient record).
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Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Nuvaxovid

for vaccination against

COVID-19

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Nuvaxovid (Novavax COVID-19 vaccine) is indicated for the active immunisation of individuals aged 12 years and over for the prevention of COVID-19 caused by SARS-CoV-2.
Inclusion criteria	- Individuals aged 12 years and over. - Eligible under current national COVID-19 vaccination programme. - Informed consent obtained. - No contraindications to the vaccine.
Exclusion criteria	- Known hypersensitivity to the active substance or any excipients. - History of anaphylaxis to any vaccine component. - Acute severe febrile illness (postpone until recovery). - Individuals with confirmed COVID-19 infection (defer until recovered).
Cautions	- Observe for at least 15 minutes post-vaccination in individuals with history of allergies. - Caution in individuals with bleeding disorders or on anticoagulants. - Inform about common side effects and when to seek medical attention. - Use as per national vaccination schedule and guidance.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Nuvaxovid
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Protect from light. Do not freeze.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection, preferably in the deltoid muscle.
Dose and frequency	0.5 mL per dose. Primary course: 2 doses 3 weeks apart. Booster: as per national guidance.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per dose.
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Minimum interval of 3 weeks between primary doses; booster interval per guidance.
Adverse effects	Pain at injection site, fatigue, headache, muscle pain, fever. Rare: allergic reactions. Refer to SmPC.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://coronavirus-yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP if appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
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Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		25/8/2025
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/8/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Comirnaty

for vaccination against

COVID-19

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Comirnaty (Pfizer-BioNTech COVID-19 vaccine) is indicated for the active immunisation of individuals aged 12 years and over for the prevention of COVID-19 caused by SARS-CoV-2. NB. This PGD covers both the KP.2 variant alongside the LP.8.1 adapted variant COVID-19 vaccine until 9th October 2025. From 10th October 2025, only the LP.8.1. adapted variant COVID-19 vaccine will be available.
Inclusion criteria	- Adults and children over 12 years old. (The vaccine to be administered must be licensed for the age of the patient. Follow the SPC for that product.) - Where the patient requires immunisation but does not qualify for NHS vaccination OR where the patient qualifies for NHS vaccination but prefers to have the vaccine privately - Informed consent obtained. - No contraindications to the vaccine.
Exclusion criteria	- Known hypersensitivity to the active substance or any excipients. - History of anaphylaxis to any vaccine component. - Acute severe febrile illness (postpone until recovery). - Individuals with confirmed COVID-19 infection (defer until recovered).
Cautions	- Observe for at least 15 minutes post-vaccination in individuals with history of allergies. - Caution in individuals with bleeding disorders or on anticoagulants. - Inform about common side effects and when to seek medical attention. - Use as per national vaccination schedule and guidance.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Cominarty
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store at -90°C to -60°C in original packaging. Thawed vaccine can be stored in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C) for up to 10 weeks.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection, preferably in the deltoid muscle.
Dose and frequency	Primary series: 0.3 mL per dose. Two doses at least 3 weeks apart. Booster doses as per national guidelines.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.3 mL per dose.
Maximum or minimum	Minimum 3 weeks between primary doses; booster interval per

treatment period	guidance.
Adverse effects	Pain at injection site, fatigue, headache, muscle pain, chills, fever. Rare: myocarditis, anaphylaxis. Refer to SmPC.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://coronavirus-yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP if appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

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